2026-02-28 - TRAFFIC ANALYSIS EXERCISE ANSWERS

Link to the exercise:

- https://www.malware-traffic-analysis.net/2026/02/28/index.html

Links to some tutorials I've written that should help with this exercise:

- https://www.malware-traffic-analysis.net/tutorials.html

ENVIRONMENT:

- LAN segment range: `10.2.28[.]0/24` (`10.2.28[.]0` through `10.2.28[.]255`)
- Domain: `easyas123[.]tech`
- AD environment name: `EASYAS123`
- Domain Controller: `10.2.28[.]2 – EASYAS123-DC`
- LAN segment gateway: `10.2.28[.]1`
- LAN segment broadcast address: `10.2.28[.]255`

BACKGROUND:

As dynamic go-getter at a Security Operations Center (SOC), you check the Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) system and find several signature hits for NetSupport Manager RAT from `45.131.214[.]85` over TCP port 443. The activity started on 2026-02-28 at 19:55 UTC..

Using this information, you quickly retrieve a packet capture (pcap) of the traffic from the internal IP address that triggered these alerts. It's all on you now! You're expected to write up an incident report, so someone can track down the infected computer and put a stop to this nonsense!

Armed with pcap, you intend to find that infected host.

TASK:

For this exercise, answer the following questions for your incident report:

- What is the IP address of the infected Windows client?
- What is the MAC address of the infected Windows client?
- What is the host name of the infected Windows client?
- What is the user account name from the infected Windows client?
- What is the full name of the user from the user account?

2026-02-28 - TRAFFIC ANALYSIS EXERCISE ANSWERS

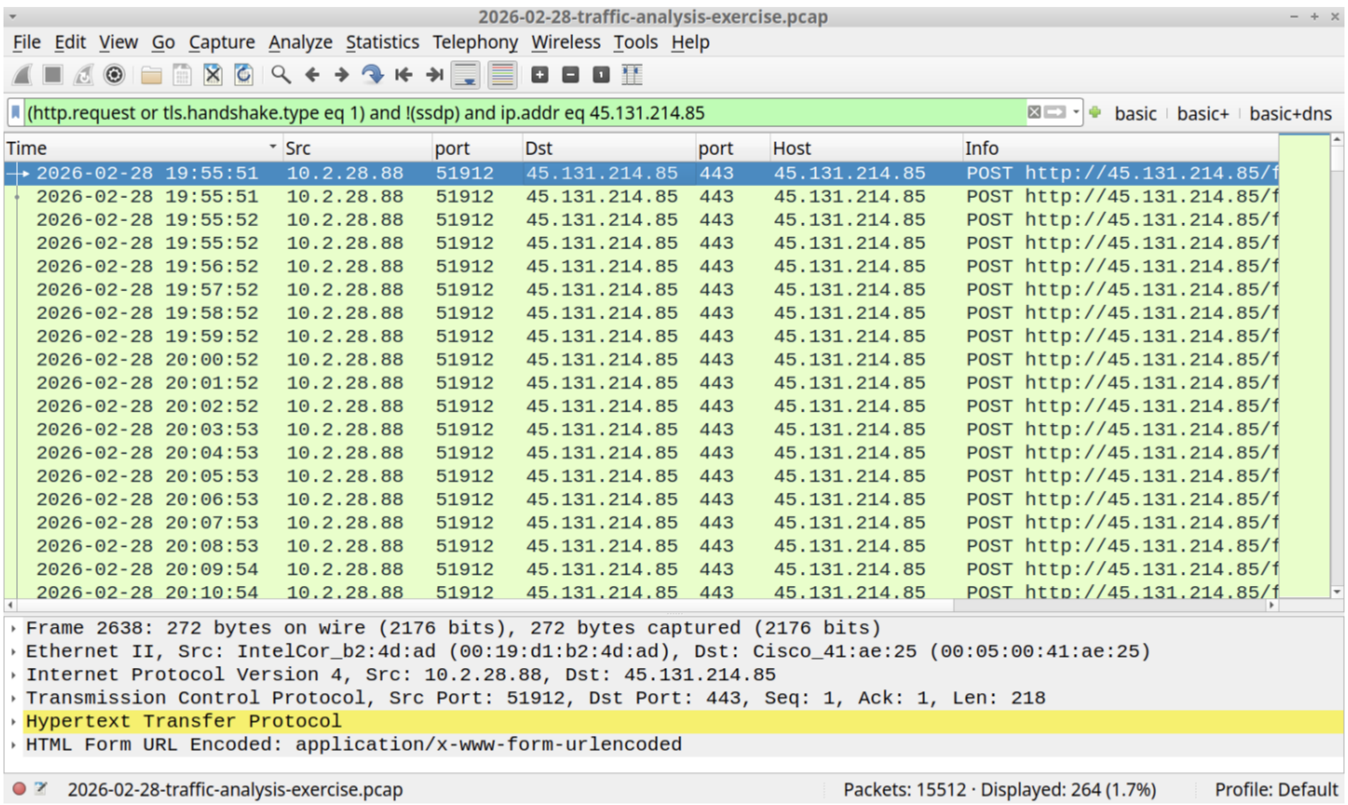
ANSWERS:

Victim Details:

- IP address: `10.1.28[.]88`
- Host name: `DESKTOP-TEYQ2NR`
- MAC address: `00:19:d1:b2:4d:ad`
- Windows user account name: `brolf`
- Full name of the user: `Becka Rolf`

NetSupport Manager RAT traffic on:

- `45.131.214[.]85:443`

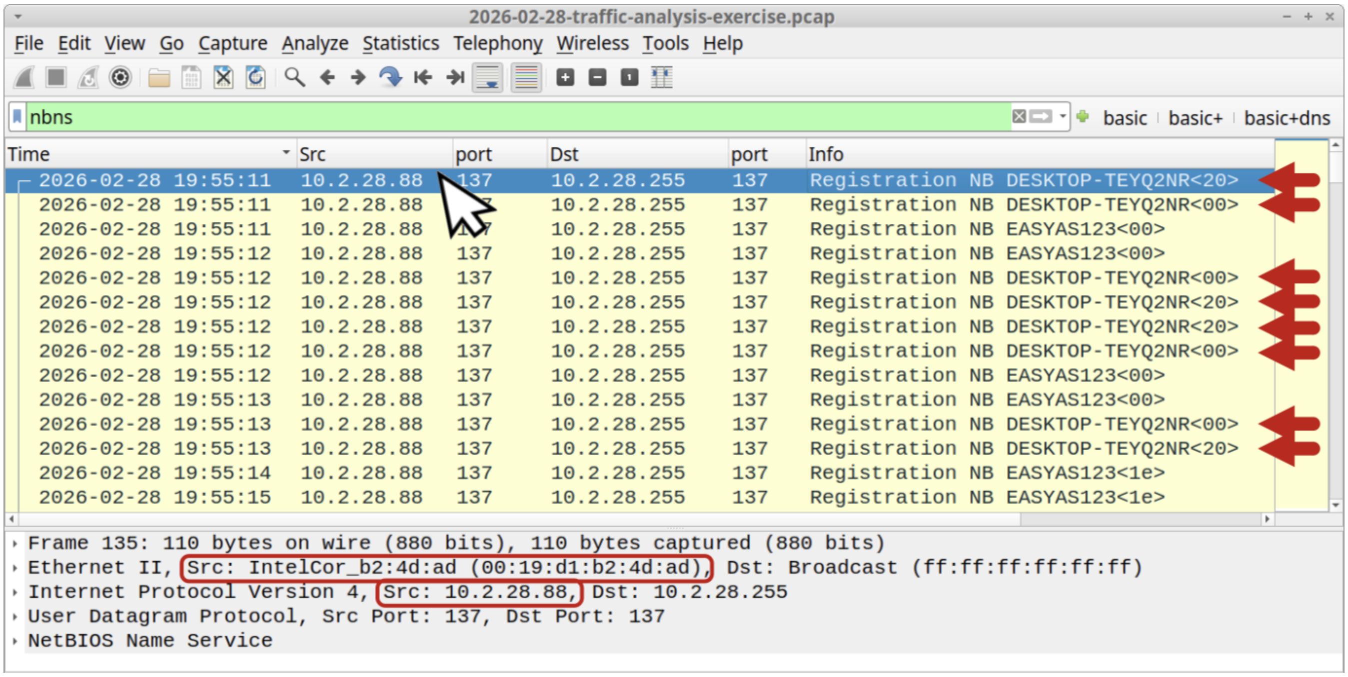


Shown above: Filtering in Wireshark to show the traffic on `45.131.214[.]85`.

HINTS:

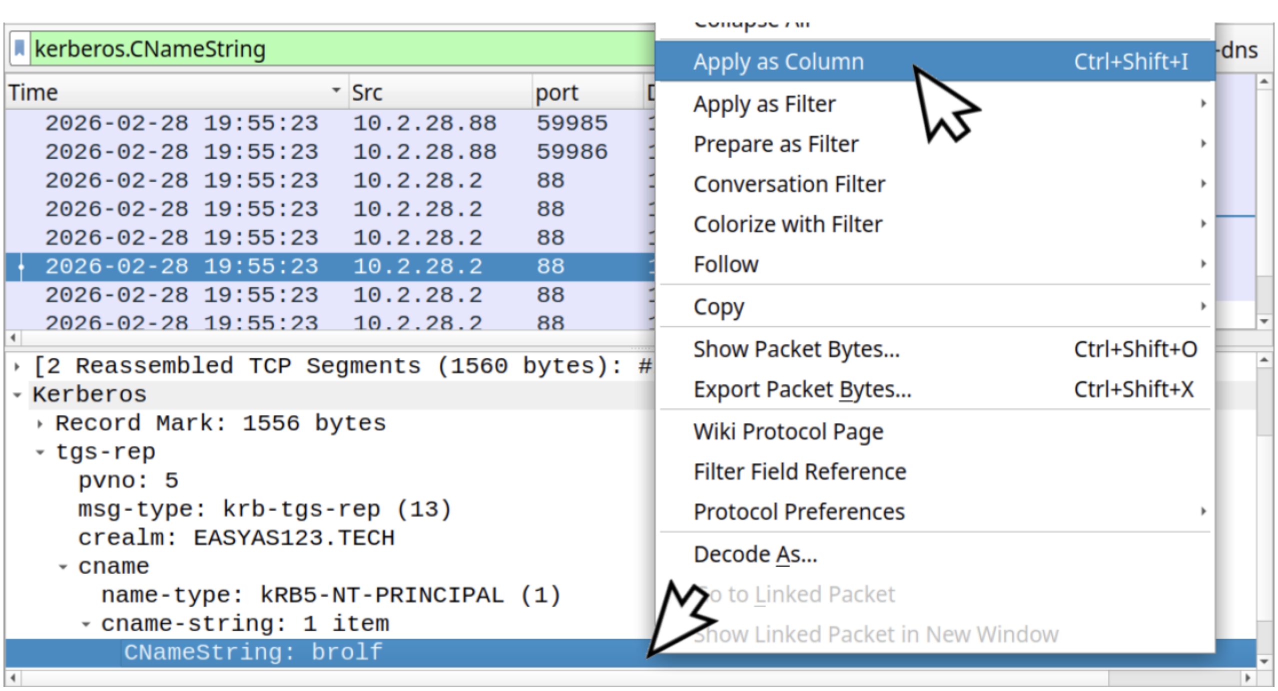
As always, since this pcap was retrieved from the infected Windows host, we can find that by pivoting on which internal IP address was communicating with `145.131.214[.]85`, which is `10.1.21[.]88`. Which you can easily see in the above image as the Source IP address in the `Src` column.

Then we can filter on `nbns` in Wireshark to find the host name and view the frame details to find the MAC address.



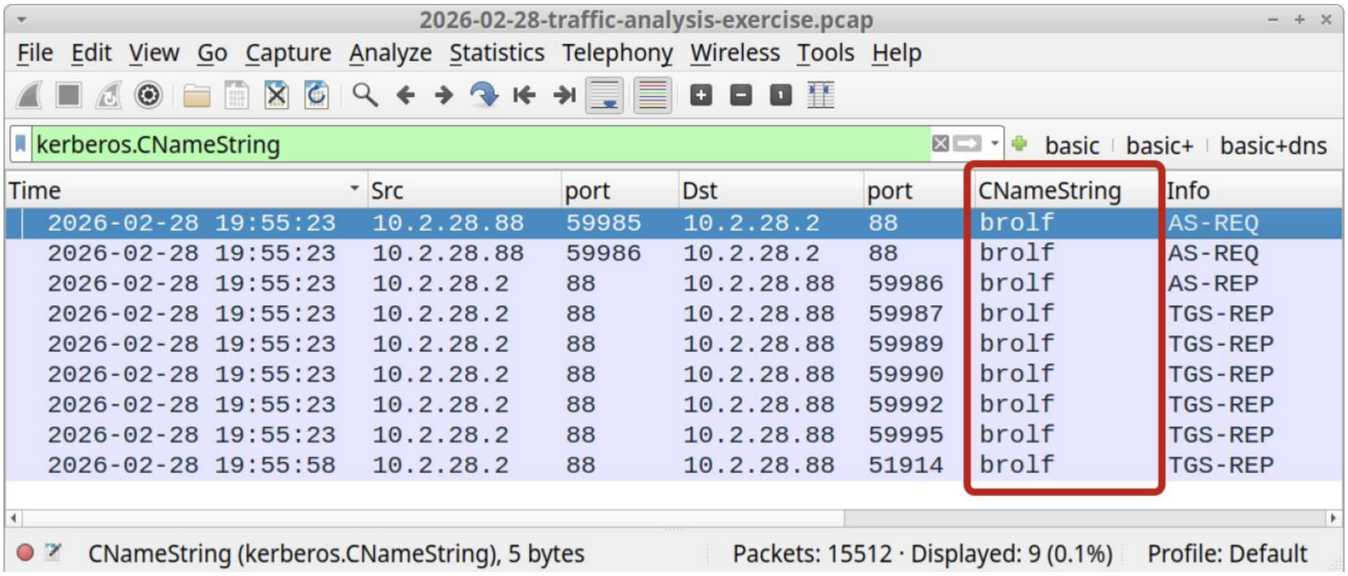
Shown above: Filtering in Wireshark on `nbns` to find the host name.

To find the Windows user account name, filter on `Kerberos.CNameString` and select any of the frames from the results. Then we can drill down into the frame details to find the `CNameString` value, which is `brolf`.



Shown above: Filtering to find the `Kerberos.CNameString` value for the user account name.

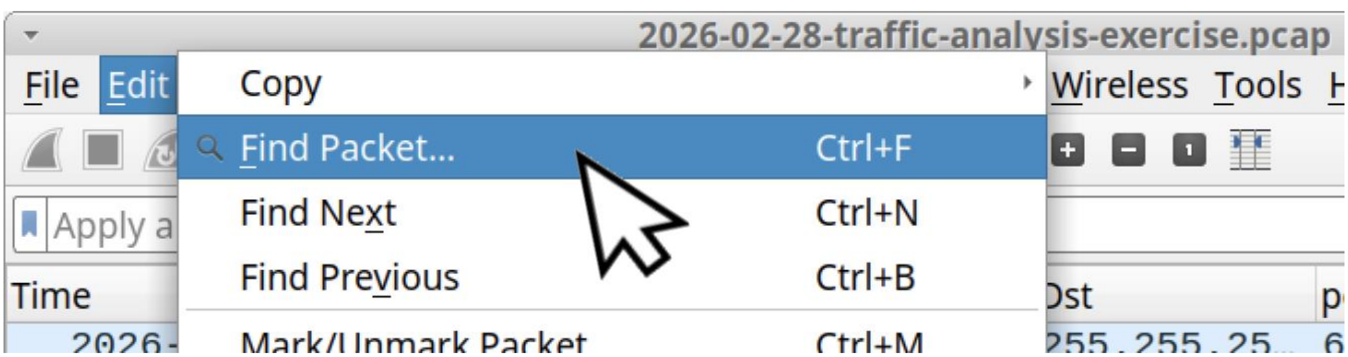
We can apply that `CNameString` field as a column, so we don't have to dig into the frame details each time we want to find the user account name in a pcap.



Shown above: The `CnameString` value as a column in our Wireshark display.

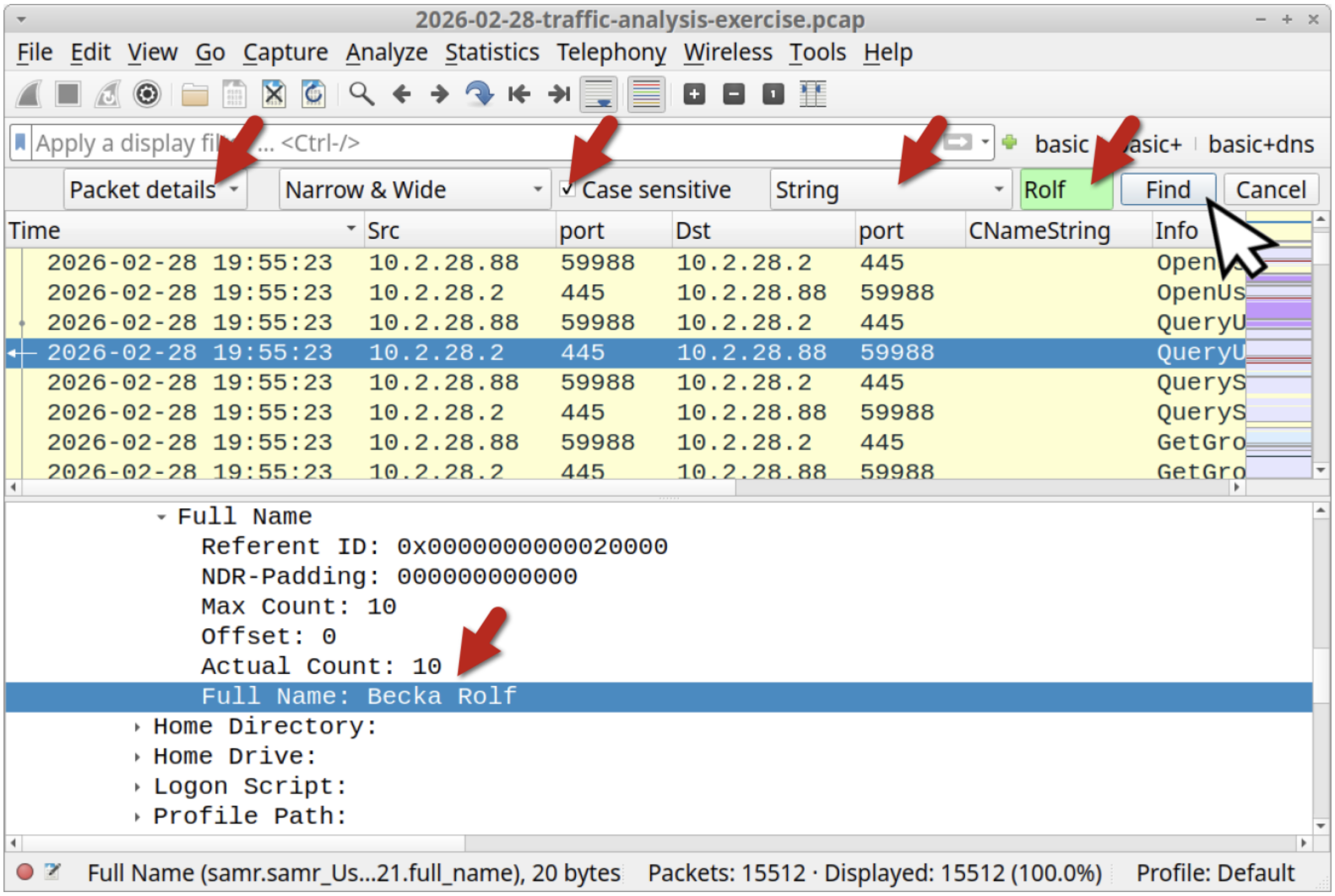
Now that we have the user account name, it looks like a first initial last name value, in this case, `b` for the first initial and `rolf` for the last name.

We can search the packet details for the case-sensitive string `Rolf` by using the **Find Packet...** function.



*Shown above: The **Find Packet...** function from the **Edit** menu.*

2026-02-28 - TRAFFIC ANALYSIS EXERCISE ANSWERS



Shown above: Searching packet details to find `Gabriel Wyatt` as the `Full Name` value.

That all I have for this month’s exercise. Catch you all next time!